AI EXPLAINED SIMPLY

Is Your AI Answer Wrong? The 30-Second Checklist

AI tools can sound sure even when they are wrong. This is general information, not legal or professional advice.

The real case

In 2023, lawyers in New York filed a brief that cited court cases generated by ChatGPT. Six of the cited opinions did not exist.

The judge, P. Kevin Castel, fined the law firm $5,000 (reported by Bloomberg Law, 22 June 2023).

The 3 checks

1. **Open the source yourself.** Ask the AI for a link or a reference, then open it. If the page does not exist, or does not say what the AI claims, treat the fact as unverified.
2. **Ask again in a new chat.** Paste the same question into a fresh conversation. If the answer changes, do not rely on it.
3. **Check every number and name against a second source.** Use an official site, a reference work, or a news outlet you trust.

Copy-paste prompts

- "Give me the source for each claim, with a link I can open. If you are not sure, say so."
- "Which parts of your answer are you least certain about?"
- "List the numbers and names in your answer so I can verify them one by one."

Quick routine (30 seconds)

- [ ] Link opens and matches the claim
- [ ] Same answer in a second chat
- [ ] Numbers and names confirmed by another source

Source

- Bloomberg Law, "Phony ChatGPT Brief Leads to $5,000 Fine for NY Lawyers": https://news.bloomberglaw.com/bloomberg-government-news/chatgpt-phony-legal-filing-case-gets-lawyers-a-5-000-fine

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